

1 HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION NO. 44

2 INTRODUCED BY Z. WIRTH, B. GILLESPIE, M. YAKAWICH, B. BEARD, S. FITZPATRICK, D. BEDEY, E.
3 BYRNE, P. FIELDER, C. HINKLE, S. KELLY, G. KMETZ, T. MILLETT, B. MITCHELL, M. NIKOLAKAKOS, L.
4 REKSTEN, K. WALSH

5
6 A JOINT RESOLUTION OF THE SENATE AND THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE STATE OF
7 MONTANA REQUESTING AN INTERIM STUDY OF ENDOCRINE-DISRUPTING CHEMICALS AND WATER
8 QUALITY; AND REQUIRING THAT THE FINAL RESULTS OF THE STUDY BE REPORTED TO THE 70TH
9 LEGISLATURE.

10
11 WHEREAS, human reproduction is declining around the world, affecting men, women, and children;
12 and

13 WHEREAS, the decline in reproduction is attributed to unhealthy lifestyles and chemicals in the
14 environment; and

15 WHEREAS, endocrine-disrupting chemicals, such as phthalates, bisphenol A, flame-retardants, and
16 pesticides, interfere with the body's hormonal systems; and

17 WHEREAS, these endocrine-disrupting chemicals are found in toys, plastic drinking bottles, cleaning
18 supplies, house dust, home furniture, electronics, building materials, fragrances, food, food packaging, personal
19 care products, and drinking water; and

20 WHEREAS, exposure to endocrine-disrupting chemicals may contribute to attention deficit hyperactivity
21 disorder, asthma, obesity, and early puberty in children; thyroid disorders, breast cancer, diabetes, obesity, and
22 infertility in women; and thyroid disorders, diabetes, obesity, infertility, prostate cancer, and low sperm count in
23 men; and

24 WHEREAS, declining birth rates and increasing life expectancy may create a "demographic time bomb"
25 as future generations struggle to meet the needs and obligations of an older population, thereby reducing
26 economic growth, decreasing tax revenue, and increasing health care costs; and

27 WHEREAS, declining sperm counts, diminished ovarian reserves, and increasing miscarriage rates
28 could eventually threaten survival of the human race; and

1 WHEREAS, as a modest first step to combat what could become a global calamity, the Montana
2 Legislature should examine the threats of these chemicals in our drinking water.

3
4 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE AND THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF
5 THE STATE OF MONTANA:

6 That the Legislative Council be requested to designate an appropriate interim committee or statutory
7 committee, pursuant to section 5-5-217, MCA, or direct sufficient staff resources to:

8 (1) review how existing state water quality laws and federal acts, including the Clean Water Act
9 and the Safe Drinking Water Act, protect water quality in Montana and regulate endocrine-disrupting chemicals;

10 (2) analyze research related to the health effects of endocrine-disrupting chemicals;

11 (3) determine, if possible, the prevalence of endocrine-disrupting chemicals in Montana; and

12 (4) offer recommendations for future study, rulemaking, or changes to law related to water quality
13 and endocrine-disrupting chemicals.

14 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that if the study is assigned to staff, any findings or conclusions be
15 presented to and reviewed by an appropriate committee designated by the Legislative Council.

16 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that all aspects of the study, including presentation and review
17 requirements, be concluded prior to September 15, 2026.

18 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the final results of the study, including any findings, conclusions,
19 comments, or recommendations of the appropriate committee, be reported to the 70th Legislature.

20 - END -